



Prime Movers

Meeting the Moment

May 26 - 28, 2026

Washington, D.C.

A message from Swanee.

Dear Prime Movers,

As we stand one week from our gathering in Washington, D.C., I woke up this morning feeling a rush of anticipation of what we'll create together starting Tuesday. I say "starting" because this is no ordinary convening — it is a rare convergence of minds and hearts, where we step into an ever-evolving space designed for the deepest questions of our time.

I'm hosting this gathering because we're at an inflection point in global history, one that demands not just strategy, but soul. Next week we'll have the rare opportunity as a group of some of the most powerful social activists in the world's lone superpower to wrestle with what it means to lead through complexity, division, and possibility.

As you prepare, please consider these guiding questions:

Who am I at the core, and why is it right for me to be here, and why am I committed to meeting this historic moment?

Who are we at our core — as individuals within this group and as a whole? What strengths can we call on — inside ourselves and collectively — to meet this moment?

These are not questions for exercises, but for the very architecture of our time together. They will frame your/our inquiry, sharpen our dialogue, illuminate the path forward, propel our pace...

It's an honor to host you for what promises to be a transformative encounter — one that will echo in your work and in the world long after we depart.

With eager expectation and love,

Swanee

Ambassador Swanee Hunt

Welcome, Prime Movers.

In a few weeks, two cohorts will meet in DC for several days. The first are Prime Movers — folks who have been doing political, peacebuilding, and movement work in the conditions that make that work hardest. The second are Next Generation Leaders, doing their own version of that work in a political moment none of us trained for. That's the convening we'll be building with you. We're calling it *Meeting the Moment*, and the title is apt — this is a gathering for the moment we're actually in. The calendar's a coincidence.

We'll be holding the room with you. We're with Centella, where we work with political leaders and movement builders, and convenings like this one (rooms full of people doing real work, in the same physical space, on purpose) are a big part of what we do. Swanee asked us to co-facilitate because the lineage Prime Movers represents is the work we believe in. So: not a neutral facilitation gig for us. We have skin in this game.

In the couple of days we'll spend together, our time will settle into three rhythms. Working sessions on the questions you bring with you. Slower time — time to think, time to figure out what you want to do next, on your own clock. And the rest of it: coffee, walks, and the side conversations that always end up mattering more than what was actually on the agenda.

Come with the questions you don't get to ask anywhere else — the ones you usually shelve because there's nobody around to ask them of. That's what this room is for.

If you hit a snag before then — travel, food, you name it — write us back. We'll fix it, or we'll find who can.

See you soon,

Lisa Changadveja & Pablo Defendini

Co-facilitators · Centella

A thought piece, **from you.**

Each Prime Mover is invited to contribute a written thought piece for the cohort to read in advance. Topic is your choice — what you're thinking about, what you're working on, what you're stuck on, what you'd argue with the room about.

Length: 700–1,500 words. Long enough to make an argument; short enough that everyone will actually read it.

Form: prose, not bullet points. First person. Drafts welcome — polish is not the bar.

These will be circulated before the convening and used as inputs to Day 1 mapping. The best work in this room has always started with someone putting a position on paper.

Submit to **yo@centellaglobal.com**

Due by **Friday, 8 May 2026**

Format **Word doc, Google Doc link, or plain-text email**

Come ready **to share.**

We're making time across the convening for musical and cultural performances — songs, readings, anything you'd like to bring. If you play an instrument, bring it along.

Three days, mapped.

May 26 – 28, 2026
Washington, D.C.

Tuesday, May 26		
Daytime – 6:00 pm	Arrivals & unstructured time with Swanee	TreeHouse
6:00 pm – ...	Opening Reception & welcome fare TreeTalk	TreeHouse
Wednesday, May 27		
8:00 – 8:45 am	Breakfast	Omni Shoreham
9:00 – 10:30 am	PLENARY SESSION I: Framing the Moment	Omni Shoreham
11:00 am – 12:30 pm	PLENARY SESSION II: The Landscape	Omni Shoreham
12:30 – 1:30 pm	Lunch	Aerie Conservatory
2:00 – 3:30 pm	BREAKOUT SESSIONS: Thematic Deep Dives	Omni Shoreham
3:30 – 5:00 pm	BREAKOUT SESSIONS: Relationship Building through Peer Walks	Omni Shoreham
5:00 – 6:00 pm	PLENARY III: Where Are We Now?	Omni Shoreham
7:00 – 10:00 pm	Dinner, TreeTalk, Cross Movement Ideas	TreeHouse
Thursday, May 28		
8:00 – 8:45 am	Breakfast	Omni Shoreham
9:00 – 10:30 am	PLENARY SESSION IV: "The Offense We Need" – Collaborative Strategy	Omni Shoreham
10:30 am – 12:00 pm	BREAKOUT SESSIONS: Action Planning	Omni Shoreham
12:00 – 1:00 pm	Lunch	Aerie Conservatory
1:30 – 3:00 pm	BREAKOUT SESSIONS: "Mini Pitches"	Omni Shoreham
3:00 – 4:00 pm	PLENARY V: Next Steps & Infrastructure	Omni Shoreham
4:00 – 5:00 pm	Closing Circle	Omni Shoreham
5:00 – 7:00 pm	Reflection and Individual Gatherings	Various
7:00 – 8:30 pm	Dinner & Reflections, informal goodbyes	TreeHouse

Three venues, one walking radius.



Hotel · sleep + working sessions & breakfasts

Omni Shoreham Hotel

2500 Calvert Street NW, Washington, D.C.

Check-in: Tue May 26 from 4:00 PM · **Check-out:** Thu May 28 by noon (late check-out arranged for the cohort).

Lunches in the Conservatory

The Aerie

2650 Woodley Road, NW, Suites 721 & 821, Washington, DC

TreeTalks

The TreeHouse

The Wardman Towers, 2660 Woodley Road, NW, Apt 3F, Washington, DC

Dress code: Smart Casual

No suits, no ties. Comfortable shoes.

Prime Movers.

LeeAnn Hall

Founder, Executive Director · Alliance for a Just Society

Saket Soni

Founder and Executive Director · Resilience Force

Emily May

Executive Director · Right to Be

Benjamin T. Jealous

Professor of Practice · University of Pennsylvania

Maya Enista Smith

Executive Advisor · X Sector Labs

Rinku Sen

Director · Narrative Initiative

Alexia Salvatierra

Academic Dean for Centro Latino and Associate Professor of Mission and Global Transformation · Fuller Theological Seminary

EunSook Lee

Director (Founder) · AAPI Civic Engagement Fund / AAPI Democracy Fund

Daisy Khan

Founder and Executive Director · WISE

Tony Massaro

President · 4Front Strategies LLC

Ben Burkett

A farmer and cooperative organizer

Rosanne Haggerty

President and CEO · Community Solutions

Maria Elena Hincapie

Distinguished Immigration Fellow & Visiting Scholar · Cornell University

Rea Carey

Principal · Carey Forward LLC

David Flink

CEO · Neurodiversity Alliance

Maria Theresa Kumar

President and CEO · Voto Latino

Giovanna Negretti

CEO & Founder · Centella Global

Malcolm Lazin

Executive Director · Equality Forum

Jennifer W. Chrisler

President · Hampshire College

Alan Khazei

Alan Khazei Consulting · Social Entrepreneur Consultant

Special guest

Dr. Adria D. Goodson

Director · Ford Global Fellows

Next Generation Leaders.

Beatriz Lopez

Executive Director · Voto Latino

Regina Shwartz

Director of Campaigns and Community Engagement · Consumer Reports

Fernando Mejia Lesdesma

Campaign Director · Alliance for a Just Society

Diana Hwang

Founder/Executive Director · Asian American Women's Political Initiative (AAWPI)

Cole Chandler

Executive Director · Department of Housing Stability

Riana Anderson

Associate Professor · Columbia University

Jesse Sanchez

President · Neurodiversity Alliance

Jorge Arteaga

Vice President of Movement Building · Right to Be

Jahnavi Rao

President & Founder · New Voters

Julia Collins

Founder and CEO · Planet FWD

Crystal Monds

Communications & Technology Manager · Amplify Georgia Collaborative

Jim Simpson

Executive Director · Center on Faith and Justice at Georgetown University

Sam Ames (he/they)

Civil Rights Lawyer · Threshold Strategies

Sandy Ovalle

Founder and Principal · Coyolxauhqui Strategies

Malcolm Kenyatta

Vice Chair · PA State Rep. · Democratic National Committee

Karla Thomas

Executive Director · Empowering Pacific Islander Communities